

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ A K 7 3 2
♥ 8 6 4
♦ J 5
♣ T 9 8

♠ Q T 5
♥ K Q J T 5
♦ 7 4
♣ A Q 6



♠ 9 6
♥ 9 7 3
♦ A Q 8 2
♣ 7 5 3 2

♠ J 8 4
♥ A 2
♦ K T 9 6 3
♣ K J 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♥	Pass	2 ♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			

After North's 1♥ opening South counts 12 HCP plus one length point for the fifth ♦. That is enough for a 2/1 response so South says 2♦. The partnership is now forced to reach game so North bids 2NT. This describes a balanced hand with exactly 5 ♥s and no 4-card ♠ suit. What should you bid now? South is happy to play in Notrump, and with no extra strength above the 13 points already promised, uses Quick Arrival and bids 3NT. North passes and a reasonable game contract is reached. Notice that you would bid this hand the same way whether or not you play 2/1.

Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A Q 9 2

♥ T 7 6

♦ 7 2

♣ 9 7 5 2

♠ K J 8

♥ A 2

♦ K T 9 6 3

♣ K J 4



♠ T 7 4 3

♥ 9 5

♦ Q J 8 4

♣ A T 8

♠ 6 5

♥ K Q J 8 4 3

♦ A 5

♣ Q 6 3

West	North	East	South
			1♥
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by South			

South opens 1♥. With 16 points, you respond 2♦, forcing the partnership to game. South rebids 2♥. In our style of 2/1 this promises a 6th heart. What do you rebid now?

Opposite South's 6-card suit, your doubleton is adequate support. If you had a minimum for your 2/1 response you might just jump to 4♥ to show no interest in slam. With a little extra you bid 3♥ since she knows the bidding cannot stop until game is reached. From your perspective South might have a big hand; his 2-level rebid shows suit length but does not say anything about strength. This is one of the beauties of 2/1, the bidding can be kept low while you look for the best place to play. However, this time South merely bids the game and you pass.

The hand is harder to bid in standard bidding - you couldn't bid 3♥ to show slam interest.

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8 3 2

♥ 9 6 5

♦ T 8 2

♣ Q 8 2

♠ K 5

♥ K Q J 7 4 3

♦ 7 5

♣ A K 4



♠ A T 9 7 4

♥ T

♦ J 9 4

♣ J T 9 5

♠ Q 6

♥ A 8 2

♦ A K Q 6 3

♣ 7 6 3

West

North

East

South

1♥

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♥

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♣

Pass

4♦

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♥

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by North

How do you respond with this nice hand? With 16+ points and 3 ♥s, you will insist on a ♥ game at a minimum. But there is no need to start making jump bids, so start with a simple 2♦ bid. This is natural and game forcing. North rebids 2♥ to show a 6-card suit. What do you rebid now? Now you say 3♥ to set the trump suit, and show slam interest. At this point North also shows slam interest, making a control-showing bid of 4♣. Do you cooperate? Yes, you have an easy, 4♦ bid, showing the ♦A. North has heard enough. He bids 4NT. What do you respond, playing standard Blackwood?

When partner hears about your two aces, he bids the slam.

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9

♥ Q T

♦ A K J T 8 4 3

♣ Q T 8

♠ Q

♥ A 9 8 6 5

♦ 9 6 2

♣ A 7 4 2



♠ T 7 4 3 2

♥ K J 7 2

♦ Q

♣ J 9 5

♠ A K J 8 6 5

♥ 4 3

♦ 7 5

♣ K 6 3

South opens 1♠. West overcalls 2♦. After West's 2♦ overcall both South and North know that the 2/1 Game Force is no longer on. North can therefore bid 2♥, showing at least 11 points. This bid is forcing on South for 1 round, but not forcing to game. South next rebids his ♠s, promising a 6-card suit, but also indicating a minimum strength hand. Since the Game Force is not on, South would have to make a jump bid to show extra strength.

You have nothing further to say so the partnership arrives in a safe contract.

West

North

East

South

2♦

2♥

Pass

1♠

2♠

All Pass

2♠ by South